

Even a period or (.) can be used in place of a colon (:) as a separator character and you can also omit either the user or the group from the command.

- If the username is omitted but the separator remains, it acts as the `chgrp` command and changes the group of the file.
- If the group is omitted but the separator remains, it changes the user and makes the login group of user as the ownership group of the file.
- If both the group and the separator character are omitted then only the user owner of the file is changed.

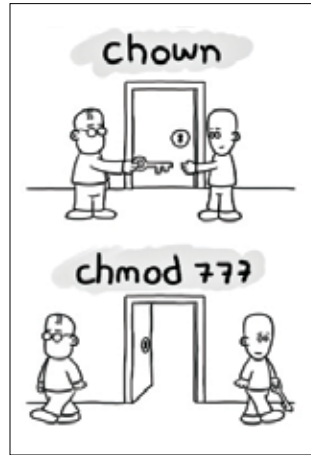
Take a look at the following examples to get an idea of the above information.

`chown user filename`

An alternate command to change only the group of the file is:

`chgrp group filename`

Note: The `chgrp` command is normally used by normal users to change the group ownership of their file while the `chown` command is usually used by root users to change group as well as the owner setting of a file or a directory.



Source: <https://devstudionline.com/>

Default Group Ownership

Each user can be a part of numerous groups, but only one group can be a primary group for a specific user. When a user creates a specific file, the ownership of that file only belongs to the primary group or the login group or the default group of the user. To change the group ownership of a particular file, the user who is the owner of that file or the root user has to change the group ownership using `chgrp` command.

The Root or Super user in File-systems

A question that arises in the mind of many new programmers these days is that we don't always use systems with multiple users these days, so why should one still worry about the related permissions?

The answer to this one is simple. Unix and its derivatives like Linux, OS X also distinguish between things run by a user, things run with administrative privileges and things run by administrator itself. Things that are integral to